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Certificate in Financial Planning: Finance majors

Advising one-pager · BBA in Finance, 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, September 2026

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/pathways

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of \$105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Every course requires **60 completed credit hours**: most students start as juniors, and students with AP or dual credit can often start as sophomores.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	For a Finance major
Fundamentals	FIN 350 (or ACC 356, if already taken)	Fall, spring	free elective
Tax	ACC 407 or ACC 357	ACC 407: fall, spring. ACC 357: fall only	free elective
Investment	FIN 410 ✓, and FIN 357	FIN 410: fall, spring. FIN 357: spring only	FIN 410 required; FIN 357 recommended
Estate	ACC 457	Fall, spring	free elective
Retirement	FIN 358	Fall only, no alternate course	free elective
Capstone	FIN 359 ✓	Fall, spring; taken last	fills the major's choose-one

The posted four-year plan, with the certificate on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	ECO 201, ACC 200, MKT 300, STA 296, <i>elective</i>	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, AN 105, <i>elective</i>
Junior	ACC 301, FIN 300, ECO 391, CIS 300, FIN 350	FIN 405, FIN 410 ✓, ACC 407 , ACC 457 , FIN 357
Senior	FIN 400-level, FIN 490 (SIE) ✓, MGT 340, FIN 358 , <i>elective</i>	FIN 400-level, AN 300, FIN 359 ✓, <i>elective</i> ×2
Pathway course	Counts for pathway and major ✓	Major requirement UK Core, <i>electives</i> <i>Italic = recommended</i> One term only

The certificate takes **four of the plan's ten electives**, five with the recommended FIN 357. FIN 410 and FIN 359 count toward the major, with FIN 359 filling the choose-one the posted plan shows in senior fall. **FIN 490 (SIE)** ✓ fills one of the three FIN 400-level slots. ACC 457's tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students, so ACC 407 and ACC 457 can share a term.

Three things to know

1. **It is free and it fits.** Four electives, and FIN 410 counts as soon as the certificate is added in myGPS.
2. **Take FIN 358 in a fall, and never leave it for last.** It has no second term and no substitute, so a student who starts in senior spring, or reaches that term without it, cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs \$895 a course).
3. **Round it out inside the degree.** FIN 357 adds the planning side of investments to FIN 410, and FIN 490 (SIE) prepares students for the SIE exam while counting toward the major.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. The experience requirement (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can both be finished after the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student (it is not required for the CFP); Finance majors can prepare for it in **FIN 490 (SIE)** ✓.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning. Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning-wip, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam. FIN 400-level slot: one of the three upper-level finance courses the major requires. Choose-one: the major's single choice among ACC 302, ACC 475, FIN 359, or another FIN 400-level course.

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Plan: posted 2026-27 Finance sample curriculum; the catalog year a student entered under governs.